Giulio Calacoci

Principal Software Engineer · Tech Lead · Platform Engineering, Software Delivery, PostgreSQL

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SUMMARY

Principal software engineer with 20 years of experience, 15 of them in the PostgreSQL ecosystem. At EDB I led the Barman team, hiring and mentoring the engineers who now write most of the project, and I created Foundation, the delivery framework that builds and ships every EDB product. My last role was in EDB's AI team, where I worked on MCP connectivity for AIDB, starting from pg-airman-mcp, an open-source MCP server I took from fork to 1.0. I'm looking for a tech lead or principal role in a team that designs and builds together.

EXPERIENCE

EDB (EnterpriseDB) · Principal Software Engineer

Sep 2020 – Aug 2026 · Florence, Italy (remote) · title formerly Principal DevOps Architect

Joined through EDB's acquisition of 2ndQuadrant.

AI team (Mar 2026 – Aug 2026)

- Recruited into the AI team as a senior engineer on the strength of pg-airman-mcp.
- Co-designed the internal MCP connections of EDB AIDB, first through pg-airman-mcp and then in internal Rust components. Part of the engineering team behind AIDB 7.7, which added an MCP endpoint and in-database agents to Postgres.
- Designed an observability layer for the AI platform and contributed to early work on agent governance.

Barman tech lead (2023 – Mar 2026)

- Led the technical direction of Barman, the open-source backup and recovery manager for PostgreSQL (3,200+ GitHub stars), with a team of up to six engineers through shared planning, design sessions and peer code review. Approved changes and shipped about 23 releases (3.4 to 3.18).
- Designed EDB's technical interview for engineering hires and sat on interview panels across several hiring rounds. Hired three engineers into the Barman team, then onboarded and mentored them; they now write most of Barman's code.
- From 2024, ran an internal PostgreSQL optimization project for EDB's cloud platform and built proofs of concept requested by the department's VP, alongside Barman.
- Second-level (expert) support engineer for Barman, handling escalations from EDB's support team.
- Advised the Barman team after moving to the AI team, until Aug 2026.

Software delivery (2020 – 2023)

- Technical lead of the team that merged EDB's and 2ndQuadrant's delivery infrastructure after the acquisition, with two direct reports.
- Created **Foundation**, EDB's GitHub-based framework to build, test and publish every EDB product to internal and customer-facing repositories: 7 OS families (RHEL, CentOS, Debian, Ubuntu, SLES, Windows, macOS) and 4 CPU architectures (x86_64, aarch64, ppc64le, s390x), on GitHub Actions, AWS and Cloudsmith.
- Replaced a complex pipeline that could not absorb the 2ndQuadrant products with a simpler design built into GitHub, cutting release preparation from days to about a day.
- Migrated the 2ndQuadrant products to EDB's infrastructure and worked with each product team to adopt Foundation.

2ndQuadrant · Continuous Delivery Manager

Sep 2016 – Sep 2020 · Prato, Italy

- Designed, built and ran the company's continuous delivery platform as its tech lead, reporting to product management: a Jenkins framework that standardised builds for every product on every supported distribution, with automated package signing and publishing.
- Cut release time from days to hours. All development teams adopted it, most of them new to CI/CD.

- Taught Python (foundations, object-oriented programming, design patterns) in a training course whose final internship brought a new engineer into 2ndQuadrant; mentored her and led her work on the platform; she later became a direct report at EDB.

2ndQuadrant · Python Developer and PostgreSQL Consultant

Aug 2011 – Sep 2020 · Prato, Italy

- Barman developer from 2013, for a time the project's only developer and its top contributor.
- PostgreSQL support engineer and disaster recovery consultant: customer support as the disaster recovery and Barman specialist (and general PostgreSQL support), consultancy, training, crisis support, and high-performance database design.
- Wrote a parser that translated Oracle PL/SQL to PostgreSQL PL/pgSQL, used to migrate customers from Oracle to PostgreSQL.
- Member of ItPUG (Italian PostgreSQL User Group) and organiser of PGDay.IT.

Earlier

- **Devise.IT s.r.l.**, Software Analyst (2009–2011): web applications in Java (Spring, Hibernate), PHP and JavaScript for e-commerce, automotive and finance clients.
- **grafica-web**, Chief Web Application Developer (2008–2009): led a small team building the front end of the company's main application.
- **Basis**, Help Desk Technician (2002–2003) at Nuovo Pignone (GE).

OPEN SOURCE

- **pg-airman-mcp**: MCP server that gives AI agents governed access to PostgreSQL (Python). Took over EDB's fork of a then-inactive project and led it to 1.0, writing 77 of the 90 commits since the fork: streamable HTTP transport, OAuth 2.0 (token introspection and JWT), DNS rebinding protection, hardened containers, purpose logging and session tracing.
- **Barman**: developer since 2013, tech lead 2023–2026, 226 commits.

SELECTED TALKS

All recorded; full list at gcalacoci.github.io/talks.

- Barman, past, present, and future of a pioneer community project, PGConf.EU 2025, Riga
- From 0 to 100: Business continuity with PostgreSQL, DataOps Barcelona 2019
- Backup and Disaster Recovery of PostgreSQL databases (workshop), DataOps Barcelona 2019
- PostgreSQL and Python, a match made in heaven, EuroPython 2017
- Step up and face the disaster, PostgreSQL Sessions #8, Lyon 2016
- Six talks in Italian at PyCon Italia (2015–2018), PgDay.IT and 5432...MeetUs!

SKILLS

- **Leadership:** technical direction, design reviews, hiring (interview design and panels), onboarding and mentoring, cross-team adoption of shared tooling
- **Platform and delivery:** CI/CD architecture, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Docker, multi-OS and multi-architecture packaging, Cloudsmith; AWS and Kubernetes (working knowledge, hands-on)
- **Languages:** Python (senior), Go (working knowledge), Rust (basics); earlier Java, PHP, JavaScript
- **Data:** PostgreSQL backup, disaster recovery, business continuity, performance
- **AI:** Model Context Protocol, agent tooling, OAuth 2.0 for agent access, tracing and governance

EDUCATION AND LANGUAGES

- Computer Science, Università degli Studi di Firenze, 2002–2008 · left to work as a developer
- Liceo Classico (Latin, Greek, philosophy, history)
- **Italian** (native) · **English** (professional working proficiency)